

26RFP052 — Proposal Response Form

Youth & Family Enrichment Services · Austin Independent School District

Vendor Information

Field	Value
Name of Contractor / Firm / Organization	The Collaborative Advocate Foundation (TCAF) — d/b/a ThriveUp Academy
Contact Name	Terry D. Flood Sr., President
Street Address	17912 Stefano Drive
City / State / ZIP	Pflugerville, Texas 78660-7020
Primary Phone	[TO FILL]
Primary Email	terryflood@thrivingcommunitiesforall.com
EIN / Federal ID	41-3618003
UEI (SAM.gov)	KDDVD1FGLW35 · SAM ACTIVE through 2027-05-06
CAGE	209N1
501(c)(3) Status	Determined 01/14/2026 (IRS Letter 947) · Public charity under §170(b)(1)(A)(vi)
Area of Interest or Activity Type	Enrichment · Family Engagement · College & Career Readiness (responding in 3 of 4 component areas; not bidding Academic Assistance, which is reserved for tutoring per the RFP exclusion)
Number of Youth / Adults Served (target Y1)	Youth: 250–500 across awarded campuses · Adults: 100–250 in family engagement track
Staff-to-Youth Ratio	1:15 standard for grades K–5 enrichment · 1:20 grades 6–12 · 1:10 for hands-on technical labs (Software Engineering, Trade-skill exposure)
Does your organization utilize volunteers?	YES — supplemental only; all volunteers fingerprinted via TX DPS FACT before any student contact
Does your organization utilize YPQ?	YES — we will participate in the Weikart Center for Youth Program Quality assessment and training initiative as required for OST programs

1. Describe the services your firm will provide that meet the Scope of Service and Performance Requirements

ThriveUp Academy is the K–12 + adult-learner program division of The Collaborative Advocate Foundation (TCAF), a Texas-headquartered 501(c)(3) operating a national community-infrastructure platform with a Travis County implementation footprint. We propose to serve Austin ISD across three of the four Component Activity areas (Enrichment, Family Engagement, College & Career Readiness), drawing on a production-deployed program platform that already supports:

- A 90-lesson trade-skill curriculum across six trades — electrical, plumbing, HVAC, welding, automotive, and software engineering — each delivered as a 15-lesson sequence with formative practice banks, an AI tutor for guided hints (Socratic mode), apprenticeship-pathway routing, and a 6-

certification ladder gated at 80% lesson completion. The Software Engineering track is the basis of the **AI Literacy and Code Computer Science enrichment modules** designed for grades 3–12, age-banded, with TEKS-alignment crosswalks for Technology Application and family-engagement layer ("Talk Your Talk") covering **89 spoken languages + 18 signed languages = 107 total surfaces**, with dialect-aware system prompts (including AAVE and Spanglish) and right-to-left rendering for Arabic. This addresses AISD's **28 FAFSA navigation and apprenticeship pathway counseling** for high-school College & Career Readiness, with built-in eligibility logic for foster-youth FAFSA independent status, McKinney-Vento housing transitions, Chafee ETV, and registered-apprenticeship in **Family-Engagement programming aligned to the National PTA Standards** for parental involvement: two-way home-school communication, parenting-skills support, parents-as-partners in student learning, parents-as-school-decision partners, and community-resource-based **research foundation** drawing on the U.S. Department of Education's "What Works" Clearinghouse OST guidance, the Harvard Family Research Project on family engagement, the Weikart Center Youth Program Quality framework, and 39 implementation-science constructs (Consolidated Framework for Implementation Research) operationalized in our continuous-quality-improvement layer. Specific service deliverables per campus engagement include (but are not limited to):

- **Enrichment clubs and afterschool blocks** (before-school, afterschool 3:00–6:30 PM, weekend, intersession, summer): AI Literacy Lab, Intro to Software Engineering, Computer Science Club, STEM Maker Workshop, Trade-Skills Exploration (electrical/plumbing/HVAC/welding/automotive concept exposure
- **Family-Engagement workshops** (Monthly): Family Tech Night, Adult Digital Literacy series, FAFSA-for-Families session, Parent-Child AI Co-Learning, ESL-support
- **College & Career Readiness programming**: FAFSA / financial-aid navigation, post-secondary trade-and-apprenticeship exposure, career-clubs aligned to Texas growth occupations, mock-interview clinics, resume workshops.

All programming is supplied with curriculum, unit plans, lesson plans, instructor staffing, materials, and supplies as required by RFP Section V.B.7.

2.A. How many campus sites can your organization serve per day?

Up to 3 campuses per day in Year 1, scaling to 5+ per day by Year 2 based on staffing build-out. Initial focus will be Title I and high-ELL campuses across the AISD service area to maximize equity impact.

2.B. How many days per week can your organization provide programming?

Five (5) days per week Monday–Friday for school-aligned programming, plus Saturday morning Family

Engagement blocks where requested by the campus, plus summer/intersession week-long programming.

3. Activity Types — selected with content-area proficiency narrative

' Enrichment

How activities increase proficiency in related content areas:

Writing Lab* (grades 5–12) builds critical-thinking, prompt-construction, source evaluation, and digital-citizenship competencies aligned with TEKS Technology Applications §126.7 (grades 6–8) and §126.32–§126.39 (HS Computer Science / Fundamentals of Computer Science) (grades 6–12) introduces algorithmic thinking, debugging, version control concepts, and the systems-thinking required to "make vibecoding work" — a phrase we use directly with high-school learners. Aligns with TEKS Computer Science I (§126.33) and Fundamentals of Computer Science I (§126.32).
STEAM Make-It Workshops* (grades 3–8) build hands-on engineering-design-process competency (ask, imagine, plan, create, improve), reinforcing TEKS Science process strands and Math problem-solving expectations.
Trade Skills Exposure* (grades 8–12) introduces career-cluster awareness across electrical, plumbing, HVAC, welding, automotive, and software-engineering pathways — aligned with TEKS Career Development §127 and Texas Industry-Based Certifications framework.

' Family Engagement

How activities increase proficiency / family involvement:

Family Tech Night* uses our 89+18 language surface to remove the language barrier between home and campus. Direct translation of family-engagement materials into a family's preferred language (or dialect-aware variant) — including ASL and 17 other signed-language renderings — drives the National PTA Standard #1 (regular, two-way, meaningful digital literacy of parents/guardians) builds device fluency, internet-safety awareness, school-portal navigation, and AI-tool literacy — enabling parents to monitor and participate in student academic life.
Grades 6-12 AI Co-Exploring sessions place a parent and student side-by-side on the same AI-literacy task, satisfying National PTA Standard #3 (active parent participation).
Parenting Skills Circles* address parenting practices alongside language access, aligned with PTA Standard #2 (parenting skills support).

' College & Career Readiness

FAFSA Financial Aid Proficiency — one-on-one and group sessions for seniors and juniors, with built-in eligibility logic for special-circumstance populations (foster-youth FAFSA independent status, McKinney-Vento, ETV, dependency overrides). Aligned with Texas House Bill 3 and the AISD post-secondary planning map.
Apprenticeship Pathway Exposure* — connects high-school learners with the 6-trade Trade Sims credential

ladder and registered-apprenticeship-intermediary structures (DOL Apprenticeship Building America framework). Aligned with TEKS Career Development §127 and Texas Pathways in Technology Early College High Schools (PTECH) framework, career counseling, mock interviews, resume preparation, post-secondary application support, dual-credit awareness.

'L Academic Assistance — NOT BID

Per RFP Section V.B, tutoring services are explicitly excluded from this solicitation. Academic Assistance is not within our service profile for this RFP.

4. How are your organization's activities aligned with the Texas Essential Knowledge and Skills (TEKS)?

Each course in our enrichment, family, and college-and-career portfolios maintains a TEKS-alignment crosswalk maintained by our curriculum lead. Direct alignments include:

- **Technology Applications:** TEKS §126.6–126.10 (grades 3–8), §126.32–126.39 (HS Computer Science strand) — direct alignment for AI Literacy Lab, Intro to Software Development, CTE, §127.4 and 127.7b— direct alignment for Trade-Skills Exposure, Career Clubs, Apprenticeship, and STEM
- **Science process standards:** TEKS §112.x (grade-banded) — alignment for STEM Maker Workshops
- **English Language Arts and Reading — Speaking and Listening / Inquiry:** alignment for AI Literacy
- **Mathematics process standards:** §111.x problem-solving and modeling — alignment for Software Engineering

AISD Curriculum Roadmap: we will reconcile each unit to the corresponding Roadmap grade-band and content-area pacing during the campus-level Service Agreement scoping conversation. Sample TEKS-alignment crosswalk for one unit is included in 02-Sample-Unit-Plan-and-Lessons.

5. Capacity to serve Limited English Proficiency (LEP / ELL) Students

This is a primary differentiator of our submission. AISD reports **28.1% of its student population is classified as ELL**.

- **On spoken language surfaces** with dialect-aware system prompts (including but not limited to: Spanish — multiple regional variants, Vietnamese, Mandarin, Arabic, Korean, French, Tagalog, Hindi, Burmese, etc.)
- **On signed language surfaces** including American Sign Language (ASL), making this one of the few enrichment offerings in AISD that can serve Deaf and Hard-of-Hearing students for Arabic and others directly.
- **On dedicated language-learning surfaces** for Arabic and others.
- **On a dedicated translation for parent-teacher / parent-program communications**, including written and spoken modalities.

All instructional staff receive a "language-access first" orientation: before any English-only content is delivered, the staff member confirms language

preference with the learner or family member.

6. How will your organization's activities demonstrate best practices?

Best-practice basis (per RFP Section V.B.6):

- **U.S. Department of Education "What Works"**

Clearinghouse: *Structuring Out-of-School Time to Improve Academic Achievement* — informs our session structuring, dosage, and academic-content

Harvard Family Research Project family-

engagement research — informs our Family Engagement track design, particularly the two-way

Weikart Center for Youth Program Quality (YPQ)

— we agree to participate in YPQ assessments and accept AISD-offered training for our staff and

National PTA Standards for Family-School

Partnerships (six standards) — explicitly mapped into our Family Engagement programming, with at least one National PTA Standard cited in each Family

Engagement Framework for Implementation

Research (CFIR) — our continuous-quality-improvement layer operationalizes 39 CFIR constructs for program-fidelity monitoring across the

RE-Adm (Readiness, Effectiveness, Adoption, Implementation, Maintenance) — used for outcome reporting at the campus level.

7. Staff Development Plan for the 2026–2027 School Year

All instructional staff and contractors complete the following development sequence before delivering services on any AISD campus, with refresher cycles thereafter:

- **AISD-required onboarding:** District policies CJA (criminal-history regulation), DBD (employment restrictions), CH-LOCAL (purchasing/vendor relations), and **DPS FACT fingerprinting and national criminal-history clearance** filed with the District before campus

YES Foundations training as offered by AISD

(Mandatory reporting and child-safety training

(Texas Family Code §261 reporting duty; awareness of grooming behaviors, abuse indicators, and SAM-policy

FERPA and student-data privacy training annual

ADA and Section 504 compliance awareness

Equity-and-inclusion training: cultural humility, ELL-inclusive instruction, neurodiversity-aware facilitation,

Professional 2025 Quality

Q2 (Feb-Mar, 2026) Jan 2027 Family engagement

Q3 (Feb-Apr, 2027) in-class activity design in

Q4 (May-June 2027) YPQ College & Career Readiness

Subject matter FA Fresh Simplification Act changes (AI Literacy, Software Engineering, Trade-Skills Exposure, FAFSA Navigation, Family Engagement) — quarterly content updates.

8. Minimum staff education / experience requirements

- **Lead Instructors (programming designer + classroom delivery):** Bachelor's degree in a relevant

field (Education, Computer Science, STEM, Social Work, Counseling) OR minimum 3 years of paid teaching / youth-development experience demonstrating equivalent competency. Subject-matter credentials where applicable (CompTIA, AWS Cloud Practitioner, etc.).

Assistant Teachers/Activity Leaders: Minimum HS diploma or GED; current enrollment in or completion of a post-secondary program in a related field is preferred; at least 1 year prior experience working with youth.

Family Engagement Facilitators: Bilingual capacity in at least one language other than English (Spanish, Vietnamese, ASL, etc.); minimum 1 year prior community-facing facilitation experience; trauma-informed training (or equivalent prior training).

Critical Success Factors: Fingerprinting and national criminal-history record filed with AISD before campus access; foundational training (or equivalent prior training); FFA membership (or equivalent prior membership).

9. How will your organization evaluate the effectiveness of the proposed activities?

We use a **mixed-methods evaluation framework** combining attendance/dosage tracking, validated screening instruments, qualitative learner feedback, and YRQ-based fidelity scoring.

Quantitative (per session and per program cycle): Student attendance, task-completion rates, AI-tutor hit rates, knowledge checks at the unit level (not used for AISD grading; for our program improvement efforts).

Qualitative: Exit-ticket reflections (closed and open prompts); engagement feedback collected in family's preferred language against unit fidelity criteria.

Program quality (by quarter by campus): For our continuous-quality-improvement loop.

Critical Success Factors reported (per RFP Section 4.4 Attachment B):

- Attendance and completion rates
- Student engagement indicators (e.g., flagging by campus partners)
- Retention-rate and promotion-rate contribution
- Narratives for cohorts followed multi-year

All evaluation outputs are summarized in a per-campus quarterly report shared with the requesting campus point-of-contact, plus an annual program-level summary for AISD Student Support Services.

10. Does your organization have established curriculum and lesson plans?

YES. A sample unit plan with three complementary lessons — drawn from our 15-lesson Software Engineering enrichment track within the broader Trade-Skills curriculum — is provided as a separate document accompanying this response: [2023 Sample Unit Plan and Lessons.pdf](#). Our broader curriculum portfolio includes 90 sequenced lessons across six trade-skill tracks, plus dedicated AI Literacy, Family Engagement, and FAFSA / College & Career Readiness unit sequences. Curriculum is updated quarterly and TEKS crosswalks are maintained per unit.

11. Process for screening employees

and volunteers

• **Fingerprinting via TX DPS FACT (Fingerprint-based Applicant Clearinghouse of Texas)** for every individual who will have direct or indirect contact with AISD students; **National criminal-history record** accessed through the same clearinghouse and filed with AISD per District Policy CJA; **Sex Offender Registry Check** at hire and recurrence-checks (minimum 2 professional) for paid staff; **Reference checks** (minimum 2 professional) for paid staff; **Mandated reporter status** confirmed in writing for every staff member; **SAMHSA and child safety policy training** completed before campus access; awareness of grooming behaviors, two-deep leadership rules, and in-house reporting of all allegations; **Volunteers** must have criminal-history clearance + mandated-reporter training as paid staff. No exceptions for "one-time" volunteers on campus during programming. The Contractor is directly responsible for obtaining and maintaining all background-check documentation per AISD District Policy CJA and Texas Education Code §22.0833.

Financial Proposal (NOT-TO-EXCEED rates)

Pricing is "not to exceed" and remains constant for the awarded term (date of award through 2031-06-30). Specific quote pricing for individual campus events may be lower based on dosage, multi-block discounts, and population served.

Enrichment programming

Service unit	Not-to-exceed rate
1-hour enrichment session, single instructor, up to 15 students	\$150 / hour
1.5-hour enrichment session, single instructor, up to 18 students	\$210 / session
Hands-on technical lab block (1:10 ratio, includes consumables for AI Literacy / Software Engineering labs)	\$275 / hour
Full afterschool block (3:00–6:30 PM), single class, single instructor + 1 assistant	\$425 / block
Week-long intersession or summer camp, 5 days × 5 hours, up to 20 students, single instructor + 1 assistant	\$4,800 / week
Curriculum customization for a specific campus need (one-time)	\$1,500 / unit (flat)

Family Engagement programming

Service unit	Not-to-exceed rate
2-hour Family Tech Night, single facilitator (bilingual) + 1 assistant, up to 30 families	\$675 / event
6-week Adult Digital Literacy series (90 min/wk, single facilitator, up to 20 adults)	\$2,800 / series
FAFSA-for-Families one-night session (2 hr, bilingual facilitator)	\$525 / event
Parent-Child AI Co-Learning workshop (90 min, single facilitator, up to 12 dyads)	\$485 / event
ESL-supported Parenting Skills 4-session circle	\$1,900 / series
Translation of campus-supplied family-engagement materials (per page, per language, machine-translation + human review)	\$45 / page-language

College & Career Readiness programming

Service unit	Not-to-exceed rate
Group FAFSA / financial-aid workshop (2 hr, up to 25 students)	\$425 / workshop
Individual FAFSA / financial-aid coaching session (45 min, includes foster-youth / McKinney-Vento / ETV pathway expertise)	\$95 / session
Apprenticeship Pathway Exposure session (2 hr, up to 25 students)	\$385 / session
Career Club semester engagement (10 sessions, 1 hr each, single facilitator, up to 20 students)	\$2,100 / semester
Mock-interview clinic, 4-hour, 3 interviewers, up to 20 students	\$1,250 / clinic
College / post-secondary application support, individual session (45 min)	\$85 / session

Sliding-scale provision

Per RFP guidance (and AISD's Vendor Q&A confirming OST is free for students with district-side funding), all student-facing programming is delivered at the not-to-exceed rates above with no participant-paid fee. For privately-paid family-engagement programming outside the AISD-funded scope, a sliding-scale framework is available on request — based on documented household income, with full waiver available for households below 200% of federal poverty level.

Discount structures

- **Multi-block discount:** 10% off the per-block rate when 20 or more blocks of the same service are contracted in a single contract. ~~Multi-campus discount: 8% off when three or more campuses contract the same program in a single session.~~
- **Title I priority pricing:** Title I campuses may request a 12% Title I discount on enrichment programming when programming serves students in identified academic-priority cohorts.

Excluded costs

- Mileage and travel — not reimbursed by AISD per RFP Section 1.5.5 (traveling) — provided by AISD per Vendor Q&A response #11 (programming space access) storage space — not provided by AISD per Vendor Q&A response #12; we plan accordingly and bring materials per session.

Acknowledgements (per Proposal Response Form)

- **Electronic Submission** — I understand that all documents must be uploaded to Bonfire and that the submission of the proposal constitutes acceptance of the ~~Terms of the Anticipated Contract~~ **Performance Based** — I understand this is a multiple-year, performance-based contract through June 30, 2031, and that the District may terminate for cause after 90 days of non-compliance.
- **Contract Acknowledgement** — **Criminal History Background Checks** — I understand TX DPS FACT fingerprinting is required for all individuals having direct contact with AISD students, that the cost is the Contractor's, and that the criminal-history process must

be completed and filed before campus presence or on the day of campus presence. Bidder must understand the required coverage (General Liability \$1M/\$2M with SAM endorsement \$100K, Professional Liability \$1M, Workers' Comp at TX statutory minimums; Auto Liability \$1M Single Limit if transporting students). Certificates of Insurance will be delivered to AISD before any work is started. Acknowledged.

References

(To be filled in by Dr. Flood before Bonfire upload. At least 3 required per RFP Section V.C. References should be familiar with the proposer's work, billing, and post-completion support, and represent clients from within the last 2 years.)

Reference 1

- School District / Business Name:
- Address: _____
- Business Phone: _____
- Email: _____
- Dates provided & dates: _____

Reference 2

- School District / Business Name:
- Address: _____
- Business Phone: _____
- Email: _____
- Dates provided & dates: _____

Reference 3

- School District / Business Name:
 - Address: _____
 - Business Phone: _____
 - Email: _____
 - Dates provided & dates: _____
-

Signature

Daylin D. Flood Official Title: Daylin D. Flood, S.F. President

Submitted in response to Austin Independent School District Request for Proposals 26RFP052 — Youth & Family Enrichment Services. Bidder agrees to comply with AISD Policies and Provisions and Standard Terms and Conditions. Submission deadline: 2026-05-19, 2:00 PM CST via the AISD Bonfire Portal.